

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

2016-03-26

To the chosen recipients of Abdul-Bahás

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26 March 2016

To the chosen recipients of ‘Abdu’l-Bahá’s

¹ Tablets of the Divine Plan, the Bahá’ís of the

United States and the Bahá’ís of Canada

² Dearly loved Friends,

^{38.1} We cannot allow this historic moment to pass without
adding—to our message to the believers worldwide—a word
to those whom the Author of the Divine Plan singled out
for a sacred responsibility and whose triumphs and travails
shaped much of the past century in accordance with His high
³⁹ expectations.

^{38.2} Soon after the ascension of Bahá’u’lláh, ‘Abdu’l-Bahá
determined that one of the principal objectives of His ministry
would be to establish a community in North America under
³⁹ the banner of His Father’s Cause. He dispatched teachers,

illuminated pilgrims, embarked upon an unparalleled visit in His

⁴⁰ declining years, laid the cornerstone of your House of Worship, carved in fourteen
Tablets addressed to you a divine mission,

and “out of the abundance of His heart chose to bestow on His

⁴¹ favored disciples, to the very last day of His life, the tokens of His unfailing solicitude." Later, at a time when the believers in

the Cradle of the Faith were hamstrung by persecution, when

the light of the Faith in Europe was eclipsed by the growing

spectre of another war, when the most vibrant center in central

⁴² Asia was dismantled, and even the world center of the Faith itself was disrupted by a conflagration in the Holy Land, the

"one chief remaining citadel," the "mighty arm" that still raised

⁴³ aloft "the standard of an unconquerable Faith," was, Shoghi Effendi observed, "none other than the blessed community of

the followers of the Most Great Name in the North American

continent." He placed you—the Plan's chief executors and its

coexecutors—among the vanguard of Bahá'u'lláh's resistless

⁴⁴ legions.

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⁴⁶ FRAMEWORK FOR ACTION^{38.3} It is impossible here to recount the range of your illustrious

achievements during the past century. You have already accom-

plished that which is worthy of the gratitude and admiration of

⁴⁷ the entire Bahá'í world, but your mission is far from complete.

After a century of resolute action, you should, more than ever

⁴⁸ before, be able to discern the straight path traced by heavenly inspiration across the many stages of the Divine Plan since its systematic execution began in 1937, and thus grasp the

full implications of the latest stage about to open. The tasks

⁴⁹ confronting you are not identical with those of an earlier age.

⁵⁰ With the international spread of the Faith largely concluded, demands on you are now most pressing on the homefront. The process of entry by troops that emerged so tenuously in

the Ten Year Crusade, and was fostered in the decades that

⁵¹ followed, is now being extended through a sound process of community building in center after center in all those countries

and territories that ‘Abdu’l-Bahá marked out so long ago. Your

52 sister communities, so many of which you helped to establish,

are now mature, and you stand with them ready to take on the

53 sterner challenges that lie ahead. The movement of your clusters to the farthest
frontiers of learning will usher in the time antici-

54 pated by Shoghi Effendi at the start of your collective exertions,

55 when the communities you build will directly combat and eventually eradicate the
forces of corruption, of moral laxity,

56 and of ingrained prejudice eating away at the vitals of society.

38.4 This is a time for jubilation. Take pride in the sacrifices and

39 victories of so many devoted souls who arose in response to ‘Abdu’l-Bahá’s call. With
the same spirit of renunciation shown

by your predecessors, cast away the idle fancies and distractions

of a world that has lost its way that you may consecrate

40 yourselves in the next five years to the priceless opportunities and inescapable
obligations of the latest stage of a spiritual

41 enterprise on which the fate of humanity ultimately depends.

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]